

Use Case Manual Disability Card



A Use Case Manual is a description of a specific use case for the EU Digital Identity Wallet. It includes an introduction to the use case and the user journey, the state of play of the use case development, as well as references to the relevant technical specifications and infrastructures, legislation, and governance structures.

The Use Case Manual is designed for the Wallet implementers, Member States and other stakeholders interested in the development of the Wallet and its use cases.

The Use Case Manual is not intended to contain full detailed technical specifications for the use case. However, where such specifications are available, the Use Case Manual contains pointers to them.

Description

The European Disability Card (EDC) will promote the free movement for persons with disabilities and facilitate their short stays in Member States other than the one in which they reside. The EDC will serve as a proof of recognised disability status or of an entitlement to specific services based on a disability. The card will grant equal access to special conditions or preferential treatment for a wide range of services, activities or facilities, offered to persons with disabilities in the visited Member State. Special conditions or preferential treatment could take the form of discounted museum tickets, free access, priority access, personal assistance, etc.

The EDC is established by Directive (EU) 2024/284, together with the European Parking Card for persons with disabilities. The Directive provides for EU-wide recognition of the EDC and foresees both physical and digital versions of the card, with the latter intended to be usable “by means of a digital identity wallet at Union level.” It will be possible for persons with disabilities to request the physical version of the card, the digital version or both. For the physical EDC, Member States are obliged to introduce it within a reasonable time after the adoption of the Commission delegated act/s (deadline for adoption 5 December 2025) and **not later than 5 June 2028**. As regards the digital version of the card, the Member States have to introduce it within a reasonable time after the Commission has adopted implementing act/s establishing the technical specifications referred to in Article 9(2). The directive has EEA relevance. Its beneficiaries are the Union citizens and their family members. Complementary Directive (EU) 2024/2842 extends the provisions of Directive (EU) 2024/2841 and both cards to third-country nationals (non-EU citizens) legally residing in a Member State.

The EDC aligns with the EU’s broader goals for inclusion and equality, freedom of movement, and digitalisation. Together, the legal and technical foundations make the EDC a high-impact wallet credential (electronic attestation of attributes).

User Journey(s)

Scenario 1

1. The user opens a transport booking website to buy discounted train tickets for an upcoming trip to another Member State.
2. During checkout, the user detects that a disability discount is available and applies for it. Then the system asks the user to confirm eligibility.
3. The user selects the EDC stored in their EUDI Wallet. With a single tap, the EUDI Wallet creates a verifiable proof of recognised disability. The booking site instantly verifies the credential and confirms the disability. The site applies the discounted fare and finalises the ticket purchase. The user receives a confirmation email without any uploads, scans, or physical documents required.
4. The EDC stays in the EUDI Wallet for future online services across the EU, ready whenever the user books another trip or registers for an event.

Scenario 2

1. The user heads to a museum in a neighbouring Member State that offers reduced entrance fees for people with recognised disabilities.
2. At the ticket counter, the staff member asks for proof of eligibility to apply the reduced rate.
3. The user opens the EUDI Wallet on their phone and selects the European Disability Card.
4. With a simple NFC tap or QR scan, the EUDI Wallet generates a verifiable presentation of the European Disability Card.
5. The museum’s system verifies the credential on the spot.
6. The user pays the reduced fee and walks straight in without presenting any physical disability documents, showing any extra medical record details, and nothing more than their phone.
7. The EDC can be reused to benefit from other available special conditions or preferential treatment provided by different services, such as other cultural or sport sites, public transport, or events, retail, etc. across the EU until it expires or is revoked.

Use case impact

Embedding a verifiable digital version of the card into the EUDI Wallet enhances ease of use and legal recognition across Member States, while significantly reducing administrative burden and fraud risk. The EUDI Wallet itself will be accessible in line with the requirements of annex I of Directive 2019/882, thus benefiting the experience of cardholders.

Benefits

End-user/citizen value

- *Selective disclosure:*
For persons with disabilities, the EUDI Wallet-based EDC enables secure and seamless access to entitlements across Member States. It empowers users to control their own credentials and share only the data necessary in a given context.
- *Fewer printed documents and greater autonomy:*
Users no longer need to exclusively rely on physical cards or printouts. EUDI Wallet-based credentials can be self-managed, updated digitally, and used seamlessly across service types and Member States.
- *EU-wide recognition:*
Access to special conditions and preferential treatment (e.g., transport discounts, free / discounted entry to museums, cultural and sport sites and events, assistance in services and facilities, etc.) without a need to undergo disability assessment in the respective Member State.

- *Reduced risk of loss or damage:*
If the device is lost or replaced, the credential can be reissued in line with national rules in place without requiring a full application process.
- *Support for accessibility-by-design:*
Credential rendering and usage flows in the EUDI Wallet follow accessibility requirements of Annex I of Directive 2019/882.

Value for service providers

Public and private entities offering disability-related benefits can simplify and secure their access management using verifiable credentials issued under the EUDI Wallet trust model.

- *Faster onboarding and verification:*
Status is proven in seconds, without requiring paperwork or manual checks.
- *Cross-border service enablement:*
Enables providers to recognise disability status from any EU Member State without any bilateral agreements.
- *Decreased administrative burden*
linked to processing the national disability cards and certificates in the national languages.

Value for public authorities

Issuing authorities and municipalities in Member States benefit from a harmonised framework supported by the EUDI Wallet that enables secure, compliant, and user-friendly delivery of disability credentials.

- *Legal compliance:*
Directive (EU) 2024/2841 requires Member States to issue a European Disability Card and to provide a complementary digital version. Using the EUDI Wallet helps authorities meet this obligation efficiently.
- *Regulatory alignment:*
Fully supports GDPR-compliant data handling through selective disclosure and local verification.
- *Cost efficiency:*
Reduces administrative workload and printing costs by allowing some users to rely on a digital card instead of requesting a physical one.
- *Digital inclusion strategy:*
The accessibility features of the EUDI Wallet will provide accessible credential delivery for citizens with functional limitations (alongside the QR-based card format).

Economic value and potential market size

According to Eurostat, 23.9% of people aged 16 years or over in the EU reported having a disability (activity limitation) in 2024. It is estimated that around 30 million EU residents have a recognised disability status that can entitle them to special conditions and preferential treatment provided to persons with disabilities. [Source](#)

The implementation of the EDC in the context of the EUDI Wallet marks an opportunity for the EU’s digital identity ecosystem, since the potential user base is significant. [Public consultation results](#) (accompanying the Commission proposal of Directive establishing the

European Disability Card and the European Parking Card for persons with disabilities that took place in 2023) confirm demand:

- **73%** of respondents with disabilities reported that the **lack of mutual recognition** (i.e. having to re-prove their status when crossing borders) across borders is a major obstacle.
- **70%** said the EDC must be available in **both physical and electronic format** to be effective.
- The main sectors identified as priorities were **public transport (54%)**, **cultural activities (47%)**, and **parking rights (46%)** – all of which represent large and recurring markets for eligibility verification.

Digitally enabling the EDC in the EUDI Wallet would therefore create a pan-European market of millions of active users and tens of thousands of relying parties (transport operators, cultural institutions, municipalities, and private sector providers), supporting seamless cross-border participation in social, cultural, and economic life, while reducing friction and administrative costs for issuers and verifiers.

Relying parties

Providers of services offered to people with disabilities will be the main verifiers of the European Disability Card. These include public authorities, cultural and sports venues, transport operators, and private entities that grant discounts, priority access, or special support to individuals with disabilities. Member States implementing the digital EDC should ensure awareness and readiness across these actors so that physical access control systems, online booking platforms, and staff can reliably recognise and validate the credential.

Considerations

- The landscape of disability-related benefits varies significantly across Member States, meaning that some verifiers may rely on more automated and some on mostly manual checks.
- Smaller service providers may need phased onboarding and clear guidance to adopt digital verification processes.
- Support for hybrid verification (digital and physical card acceptance) will be necessary to ensure inclusiveness.

Synergies with other use cases

The use of a digital EDC can be envisaged in both proximity and online scenarios. According to a deliverable of the EWC pilot project, airlines, other transport providers, hospitality services, museums and other service providers have the need to check the eligibility of customers for fares dedicated to disabled people, and to collect some information concerning the specific needs of the customers. The EDC could become the credential used to communicate about and prove those needs to the different service providers.

The EDC use case benefits from strong synergies with several other EUDI Wallet use cases, like:

- *Representation:*
Parents, carers, or legal guardians can act on behalf of persons with disabilities, especially children or adults requiring support.

- *Ticket or pass:*
The EDC may be used in conjunction with transport or event tickets stored in the EUDI Wallet, allowing streamlined multi-credential presentations
- *Online payment authorisation:*
Discounts validated through the EDC can be applied directly during online purchases (e.g., ticketing platforms), enabling seamless end-to-end booking flows.
- *Photo ID:*
When required (e.g., for ticket collection or access control), the EDC can be presented together with a digital photo ID from the EUDI Wallet to confirm identity and entitlement.

Moreover, the EDC use case shares multiple technical, legal, and functional building blocks with other use cases particularly with ones in scope or social security. Those are:

- European Parking Card for persons with disabilities
- European Health Insurance Card
- Online Payment Authorisation

Use case implementation

Existing implementations

While an EU-wide implementation of the EDC within the context of the EUDI Wallet is still under development, several Member States have already introduced national solutions:

- BE, CY, FI, IT, MT, RO and SI participated in the EU Disability Card pilot in 2016–2018. Pilot cards issued were mutually recognised among the project countries. The EU Disability Card pilot is the predecessor of the European Disability Card
- **Austria:** Austria's digital disability card is integrated into the [ID Austria](#) and the “eAusweise” app, which can digitally present a person's [disabled person's pass](#) (Behindertenpass).
- **Greece:** The Gov.gr Wallet app in Greece allows users to access their digital disability card.
- **Italy:** The digital version of the European Card for People with Disabilities is available, free of charge, in the “Wallet” section of the [IO App](#).
- **Poland:** [mLegitymacja](#) is the electronic version of the identity card for all reliefs and entitlements which may be used by disability pensioners and can be added in the mObywatel [app](#).
- **Slovenia:** [Invalidska kartica ugodnosti](#) is a mobile app by the Ministry of Labour, Family, Social Affairs and Equal Opportunities allowing the use of the European Disability Card in digital form.

Legislation

The EDC is mandatory for all Member States and established by Directive (EU) 2024/2841 (same as for the European Parking Card for persons with disabilities). Member States shall adopt transposition laws by 5 June 2027, and these will apply from 5 June 2028.

Current formats for the national disability cards and upcoming formats for the EDC:

- *National documents:*
National disability cards and disability certificates can be issued by Member States according to national law; however, they are out of scope of the Directive and may be not accepted in other Member States.
- *Physical EDC with digital features:*
Annex I to the Directive defines the format for the physical EDC with a digital feature (QR code on the reverse side). Similar to the approach followed for the EU Digital COVID Certificates, when scanned, this QR code would authenticate the document contents, including a check of its possible revocation. The QR code and, where appropriate, other digital features on the physical card are to be defined in a delegated act envisaged to be adopted by the Commission by 5 December 2025.
- *Digital EDC - credential:*
the physical EDC shall be complemented by an accessible digital version by the Member States within a reasonable time after the Commission has laid down the corresponding technical specifications through implementing acts. There is no deadline for the adoption of these implementing acts. The specifications are envisaged to build on the experience on digitalisation of certificates and documents, such as the EU Digital COVID Certificate and the empowering provision refers to enabling the use of the EDC in “a digital identity wallet at Union level”.

Member States shall designate one or more competent authorities or bodies responsible for the issuance, renewal and withdrawal of the European Disability Card and the European Parking Card for persons with disabilities..

Technical specifications, software libraries and infrastructure

The technical specifications for the EDC will be determined in an upcoming Implementing Act adopted further to Directive (EU) 2024/2841.



European
Commission



EU Digital Identity
Wallet